That brings us to the end of this chapter on configuration. Configuration isn't glamorous, but it's an essential part of all apps. The ASP.NET Core configuration provider model handles a wide range of scenarios, letting you store settings and secrets in a variety of locations.

Simple settings can be stored in appsettings.json, where they're easy to tweak and modify during development, and they can be overwritten by using environment-specific JSON files. Meanwhile, your secrets and sensitive settings can be stored outside the project file in the User Secrets manager or as environment variables. This approach gives you both flexibility and safety—as long as you don't go writing your secrets to appsettings.json!

In chapter 11 we take a look at the OpenAPI specification and how you can use it for documenting your APIs, testing your endpoints, and generating strongly typed clients.

Summary

- Anything that could be considered to be a setting or a secret is normally stored as a configuration value. Externalizing these values means that you can change them without recompiling your app.
- ASP.NET Core uses configuration providers to load key-value pairs from a variety of sources. Applications can use many configuration providers.
- You can add configuration providers to an instance of `ConfigurationManager` by using extension methods such as `AddJsonFile()`.
- The order in which you add providers to `ConfigurationManager` is important; subsequent providers replace the values of the same settings defined in earlier providers while preserving unique settings.